NOVELIA AI-Powered Multilingual Reading Platform

Product Case Study | Independent Product Management & AI Prototyping Project | Built with Google AI Studio (Gemini)

Live demo: [insert URL] | GitHub: [insert repo URL] | PRD: included in repository /docs

1. THE PROBLEM

Readers struggle to discover books in their own language, and digital reading is largely passive and solitary. Publishers lack simple tools to distribute books, see reader engagement and understand earnings. Both sides juggle separate tools for routine tasks such as tracking purchases, scheduling releases and finding information.

2. TARGET USERS

- **Readers:** global readers who want books in a preferred language and a more immersive experience.
- **Publishers & authors:** independent authors and publishing companies who need distribution, analytics and promotion.
- **Platform admin:** approves publishers and books, moderates community content and reviews promotion requests.
- **Why two sides:** a marketplace needs catalog supply (publishers) and demand (readers) to work.

3. THE SOLUTION

NOVELIA is a web-first reading marketplace with **Reader** and **Publisher** portals (plus a lightweight admin view), united by an AI assistant called **ROX**. Differentiators beyond a standard e-book store:

- **StorySound:** optional instrumental, lyric-free background music matched to each chapter's mood.
- **Chapter Circle:** a post-chapter prompt ("Share your feelings till now before the break...") opening a spoiler-safe, chapter-specific discussion.
- **Launch pricing:** $2 in the first week after release, then a regular price (assumed $4; to be confirmed with the client).

4. AI USE CASES (ROX)

For readers

- Search a keyword, scene or chapter inside a book.
- Recommend similar books; summarise chapters already read.
- Set a purchase reminder (never charges without confirmation).

For publishers

- Analyse sales, completion and engagement per book.
- Suggest promotion strategy; draft book descriptions.
- Schedule releases; compare performance across titles.

Guardrails by design: role-based data access, spoiler boundaries tied to reading progress, human confirmation before consequential actions, and clear separation of real analytics from AI-generated suggestions.

5. MVP DECISIONS AND RATIONALE

- **Web-first, not native apps:** validates the concept fastest at the lowest cost.
- **Simulated payments and sample data:** proves the purchase journey without financial or compliance risk.
- **Predefined StorySound tracks:** tests whether readers value music before investing in AI-generated audio.
- **Publisher-approved editions, not AI translation:** protects quality and rights; AI translation deferred to a later release.
- **ROX kept narrow:** a few high-value, confirmable actions instead of an unrestricted autonomous agent.
- **Deferred:** real payments, advanced analytics, scheduled purchases, recommendations engine, audiobooks.

6. SUCCESS METRICS (HYPOTHESES TO VALIDATE)

Book purchase conversion • Book completion rate • StorySound adoption (target 30% of active readers) • Chapter discussion participation (20%) • ROX monthly engagement (15%) • Repeat purchase within 30 days (25%) • Publisher retention. *These are targets to test, not measured results.*

7. LIMITATIONS AND RISKS

- **Prototype status:** payments, publisher earnings and notifications use sample/simulated data; not production-ready.
- **AI reliability:** ROX may produce inaccurate answers unless grounded in book and platform data.
- **Content rights:** copyright, translation and music licensing must be verified before launch.
- **Open questions:** regular price, subscription benefits and commission split are unconfirmed.

8. NEXT STEPS

- Validate StorySound and Chapter Circle with 5–8 user interviews or a short usability test.
- Confirm pricing, subscription model and revenue share with the client; convert the PRD into a Jira backlog (epics, stories, acceptance criteria).
- Replace mocks with a real backend and payment sandbox; ground ROX in real data with evaluation tests; engage Security, Legal and Data early.